

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective November 1, 2024

Policy No. BF:06.0

**Breast Pump Inventory Management and Multi-user (MU)
Breast Pump Retrieval**

Purpose

To ensure the local agency (LA) maintains a breast pump inventory for WIC participants to initiate, maintain and increase the duration of breastfeeding in special circumstances.

Authority

7 CFR Part 246.14; USDA FNS Memorandum 99-WIC-73

Policy

Local agencies must maintain a secure and continuous inventory of breast pumps and collection kits.

Local agencies must not implement breast pump policies that are more restrictive than the state agency (SA) policies.

Definitions

Manual breast pump – A non-electric breast pump that is designed to be used by one (1) person only. Manual breast pumps allow women to express milk from one breast at a time.

Lost or stolen breast pump inventory – A missing breast pump or collection kit that is not accounted for in the breast pump inventory documentation or a loan contract.

Milk Collection Kit - A personal use milk collection kit provided with a loaned MU pump and is designed to be used by one (1) person only.

MU breast pump – An electric breast pump that is designed for mothers who need to establish their milk supply with a breast pump alone or with minimal

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breastfeeding by the infant. This pump may be used by more than one (1) person due to its closed-system design.

Single-user (SU) electric breast pump - An electric breast pump that is designed to be used by one (1) person only. SU electric breast pumps typically allow women to express milk from both breasts at the same time.

Procedures

I. Inventory

- A. Store physical inventory of breast pumps, flanges and other accessories in a clean, locked space. As a best practice, avoid storing breast pumps directly on the ground.
- B. All full-time clinics, at minimum, must maintain a physical inventory of manual breast pumps, SU electric breast pumps, MU breast pumps and collection kits. If inventory is not stored at part-time or satellite clinics, then ensure participants have access to receive the appropriate pump and appropriate flange without the need for additional travel beyond their home clinic.
- C. Document inventory of manual breast pumps, SU electric breast pumps, MU breast pumps and collection kits that are received, transferred and/or issued in the management information system (MIS).
- D. Reconcile inventory in the MIS to physical breast pump and collection kit inventory at least once a month.

II. Lost or Stolen Breast Pump Inventory

- A. Notify the SA by email immediately upon discovery of lost or stolen breast pumps or collection kits.
- B. If it is determined that the breast pumps were stolen, notify the local police and obtain a copy of the police report. Email a copy of the report to the SA along with a description explaining the circumstances surrounding the theft and include a description of the procedures instituted to ensure that the loss or theft may not readily occur again.

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- C. If the breast pumps were lost, submit an email to SA explaining the circumstances surrounding the loss and include a description of the procedures instituted to ensure that the loss or theft may not readily occur again.
- D. The SA will conduct a review to determine if the cause was negligence. If negligence is determined, the LA will reimburse an amount calculated by the SA.

III. Return and Retrieval of MU Breast Pumps

- A. When a pump is returned to the clinic:
 - 1. Return the pump into the MIS inventory system.
 - 2. Check the pump case for all parts, plug the pump in to ensure it is in good working order. If the breast pump is damaged contact your LA's Breastfeeding Coordinator for guidance.
 - 3. Clean the pump motor casing with Cavicide or a similar cleaner. Do not use bleach or products containing phenol.
 - 4. Mark the pump as cleaned and ready for issuance in the MIS inventory system.
- B. Retrieval of overdue MU Breast Pumps
 - 1. Attempt to retrieve overdue MU pumps once per week over a four-week timeframe after the original or extended due date. An irretrievable MU must be recorded as failed collection within 6 weeks of the last assigned due date.
 - a. Document each attempt as a return recovery attempt on the participant page in MIS.
 - b. At least one of the four documented attempts must be in writing. The written attempt should be sent via certified mail and in the participant's preferred language. Maintain returned letter(s) by scanning and uploading into the participant's page in MIS or document in the MIS a non-response if the letter is not returned.
 - c. If the pump is not returned after four attempts, set the return status to failed collection. No further retrieval

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- attempts are required. A failed collection status meets the documentation and reporting requirements to the SA.
- i. Food benefits must not be denied to any active participant based on MU breast pump retrieval status.
 - ii. A breastfeeding mother with a failed collection status must not be denied a breast pump for future infants if eligible for a breast pump per Policy BF:05.0.
2. If the participant reports the MU was lost or stolen, document in MIS. No further attempts should be made to retrieve the pump.
- a. Do not lend the participant another MU pump unless a police report is provided. Police and fire reports must be scanned and uploaded into the participant page in MIS.
 - b. If a police or fire report cannot be obtained, staff must evaluate the mother's needs and if appropriate, issue a SU electric pump. Contact the SA for additional guidance, if needed.
 - c. If a participant with a loaned MU breast pump transfers to another LA, the LA that issued the pump is responsible for the retrieval process. If the participant returns the pump to their new LA, then the gaining agency must complete the return process of the pump.